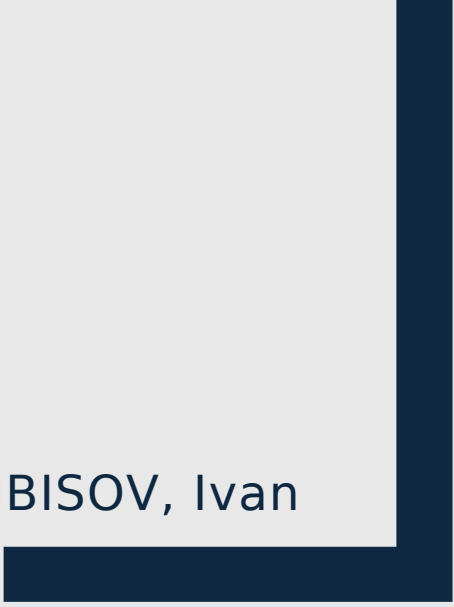




Supply chain and operations management

ANALYTICAL REPORT ON OM ASPECTS OF IBS

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Table of Contents

<i>Executive summary.....</i>	<i>2</i>
<i>Introduction.....</i>	<i>3</i>
<i>Mission statement.....</i>	<i>3</i>
Product and services.....	3
<i>Position in supply chain.....</i>	<i>3</i>
Immediate Suppliers.....	3
Immediate Customers.....	4
Supply Chain (Network) IBS is a part of.....	4
<i>Product and service development.....</i>	<i>4</i>
New possible products/services.....	4
Improvements for current products/services.....	4
<i>Location.....</i>	<i>5</i>
Real location.....	5
Factor rating method to find out other possible locations.....	5
<i>Operating system.....</i>	<i>6</i>
Process type.....	6
Process analysis.....	6
Potential bottlenecks and improvements.....	7
<i>Layout.....</i>	<i>7</i>
Relationship chart and evaluation.....	7
<i>Quality assurance.....</i>	<i>8</i>
Why-why analysis.....	9
Check list and pareto chart.....	10
<i>Summary and evaluation.....</i>	<i>10</i>
5 performance objectives.....	10
Strategic importance.....	11
<i>Appendix.....</i>	<i>11</i>
References.....	11
AI Disclosure.....	11

Executive summary

This report provides an analytical evaluation of key operations management (OM) aspects of International Business School Budapest (IBS), with the aim of identifying areas for operational improvement and enhanced competitive performance. The analysis covers the organisation's position within its supply chain, product and service development processes, facility location, operating system design, layout efficiency, and quality assurance practices.

IBS operates as a professional service organisation within the higher education sector, delivering degree programmes and supporting services to an international student base. Its position in the supply chain is characterised by strong reliance on external academic partner: University of Buckingham and internal human resource such as faculty and administrative staff.

The report identifies several strengths in IBS's operations, including a structured service offering, a strong quality assurance system supported by international accreditations, and an effective facility layout. The current location in Graphisoft Park provides a prestigious, business environment, positively impacting university's image and student experience.

However, a number of operational limitations also exist. Key bottlenecks include dependence on external programme development, limited teaching capacity due to reliance on individual teachers, and potential delays in grading processes. Additionally, accessibility issues related to the campus location and limited integration of hard skills.

To solve these problems several solutions are proposed: integration of blended learning solutions, expansion of AI and data programmes, and enhancement of career support services through guaranteed internships and stronger industry partnerships. Improvements in accessibility and affordability, such as expanded scholarship opportunities and increased availability of online programmes, are also suggested to support sustainability objectives.

The analysis concludes that IBS has a strong operational system, but some improvements in accessibility, capacity and flexibility are still needed to strengthen its competitive position. Following these recommendations would positively influence the five key performance objectives: quality, speed, dependability, flexibility, and cost, contributing to long-term success.

Introduction

International Business School (IBS) is a private business university in Budapest founded in 1991 that provide English-language business education with international degrees.

I am going to write an analytical report on certain operations management aspects of IBS and try to improve the business.

Mission statement

“IBS’s **mission** is to provide economically and culturally relevant, English-language business and management-related education to people who can benefit from it. We are demand-led and customer-focused. We enhance learning, build confidence and create an opportunity for all who choose to invest in studying at our school.” (IBS, n.d)

Product and services

IBS is a private educational institution, so the only products it produces are:

- Degrees (bachelor's, master's, or PhD).

In all other respects, IBS is a multi-service company that produces teaching services, career services, international services (Erasmus), and student wellbeing services.

Position in supply chain

Immediate Suppliers

We can divide IBS's immediate suppliers into two categories: suppliers that deliver a product (degree) and suppliers that deliver services.

1) Degree supplier:

- University of Buckingham provides bachelor's, master's, or PhD degrees, as well as language programs.

2) Services supplier:

- Faculty and staff (teachers, admiration staff): provides teaching services, career services, and student well-being services.

- Erasmus program: provides international services.

Immediate Customers

The clients are, firstly, the IBS students themselves, as well as students from other countries and universities. Secondly, these are partner institutions that receive exchange students.

Supply Chain (Network) IBS is a part of

1) University of Buckingham, Faculty, staff and Erasmus partners



2) IBS



3) Students, partner universities

Product and service development

The approximate process for creating a new curriculum at IBS is as follows. Program design and curriculum development: creating modules, teaching methods, and specializations. The program must be logical and structured, otherwise it will lose academic credibility. Next comes a financial plan to prevent budget overruns. Then comes external approval from partners and accreditation bodies to provide legal authorization, trust, and recognition. Then comes resource preparation: qualified teachers, library resources, new technologies (for example, for the IT program). The program must be highly qualified. Next comes marketing: program promotions and open days to attract students and build awareness. Finally, the program is released and monitored for student evaluation.

New possible products/services

I would add more AI to all programs. I believe AI is currently the fastest-growing field in the world, growing at an incredible rate. For example, bachelor's degrees in corporate finance and AI, marketing and AI, master's degrees in AI research, PhDs in data and AI, and so on. I would also create a separate program just for business and AI: a bachelor's degree in business and AI. There is already a very high demand for specialists who know how AI works and how to implement it in business, and in the future, this demand will increase 10 times bigger.

Improvements for current products/services

I would strengthen digital skills and data: more programming in disciplines that focus on this. I'd also add more real-world case studies; for example,

in the Excel course, you could analyze a real company and create a report. This analysis could be incorporated into your portfolio, which would greatly help with your job search. Furthermore, I'd make internships guaranteed in the fifth semester; currently, this option isn't guaranteed at the university, and you must find a job yourself.

Regarding sustainability, I think we could expand the number of scholarships available, so that they are awarded not only for academic results but also for family income, so that even low-income families could afford education.

Location

Real location

IBS is located in Graphisoft Park, which is also home to over 60 international and Hungarian companies, including Microsoft, SAP, Canon, Samsung, and others. (IBS, 2024) This location is particularly advantageous because it allows students to feel like they are in a real business environment. The location is also quite quiet, allowing students to avoid distractions. The dormitory is also very close to the university, which is a major advantage for those who live there. However, students who don't live in the dormitory aren't so fortunate: most international students (who are most IBS students) live on the Pest side of Budapest, while the university is located on the Buda side. Furthermore, it's far from the city center, so going to the university can take up to 40 minutes or even an hour. The bus to the university also stops a bit far away, requiring an 8-minute walk. If a student or professor wants to grab something to eat, the nearest grocery store is about a 15-minute walk away, but there are plenty of cafes on and off-campus.

Factor rating method to find out other possible locations

Factor	Weight	A	B	C
Prestige and business environment	30%	5	4	5
Public Transportation	25%	2	5	5
Dormitory location	20%	5	2	1
Quietness	10%	4	2	2
Groceries/cafes availability	15%	4	5	5
Weighted scores		4	3,8	3,9

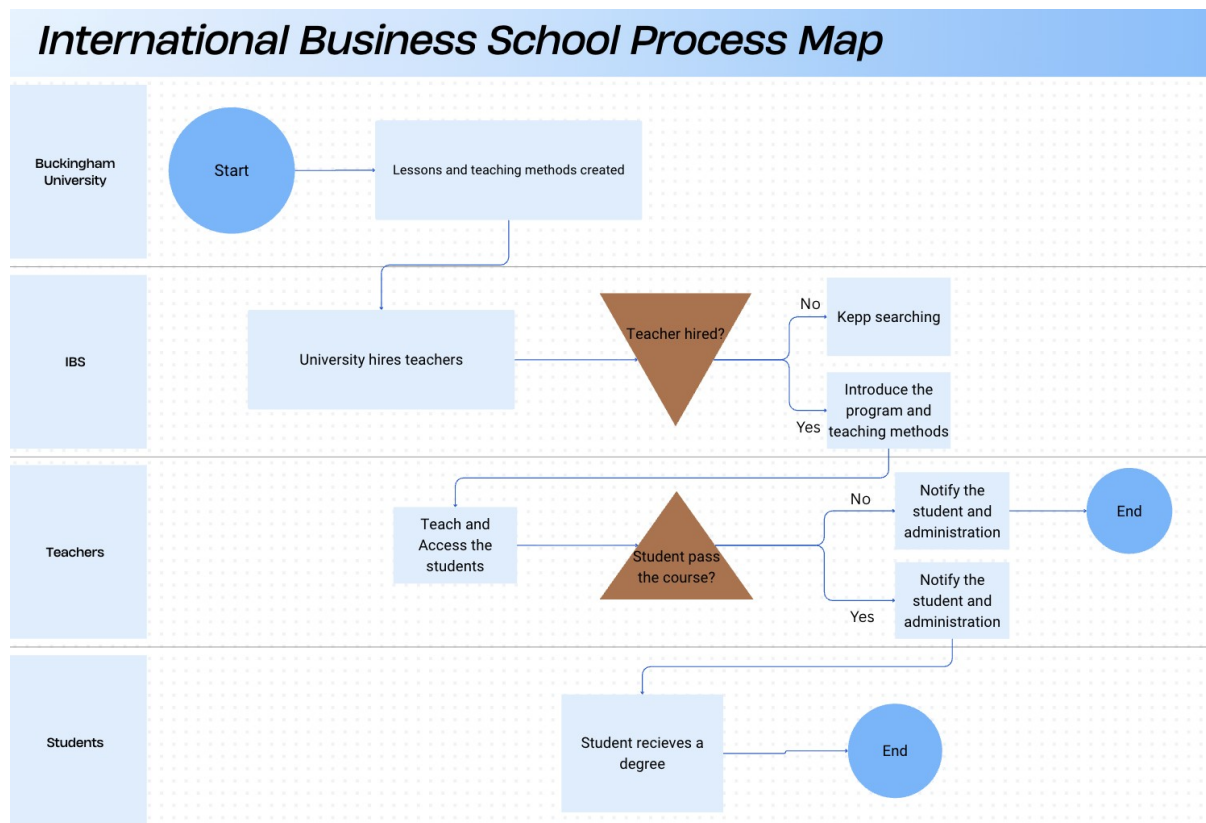
To find other possible locations, I looked at two main factors (prestige, business environment, and public transportation) and began searching for locations that satisfied both: Nepfurdo utca (option B) and Szigony utca (option C). Both locations are in business environments surrounded by large companies (Samsung in B, IBM, and Morgan Stanley in C). Both locations also have excellent public transportation and grocery/cafe availability. However, these locations are very noisy and energetic, so it's impossible to sit down on a bench and review material; there are many distractions, and the dormitory is located quite far away. Therefore, in the end, the Graphisoft Park location received the highest score, meaning that of the options I proposed, this one will still remain the best.

Operating system

Process type

I identified IBS as a professional service-type company: it has a lot of contact with clients (students and teachers). Clients (students) spend a lot of time earning their degrees. It offers a high level of customization: students choose their own program, and they can change programs if they wish. The staff actively interacts with students. IBS, as a private university, is people-based rather than equipment-based.

Process analysis



It all starts with Buckingham University, where the curriculum and teaching methods are developed. This information is then passed on to IBS, where they begin searching for teachers for specific subjects. If a teacher is found, the university explains the program and teaching methods. The teacher begins teaching students and assesses their work. If the student successfully passes all assignments and exams, they graduate and receive a degree.

Potential bottlenecks and improvements

The first bottleneck may be the fact that programs are created exclusively at Buckingham University, which could lead to limited capacity, potentially leading to delays in adapting to market needs. A second bottleneck could be the fact that training relies heavily on a single teacher. This instructor often must teach the same lecture several times, making learning highly dependent on the instructor's available hours. Therefore, blended learning could be implemented, where, in addition to direct instruction with the instructor, individual pre-recorded lectures on core material could be provided. Another problem could be that a single instructor grades all the work in their class, which could lead to either inconsistent grading or delays in grading. A solution could be the introduction of assistants (either human or AI assistant) to support fast and consistent grading.

Layout

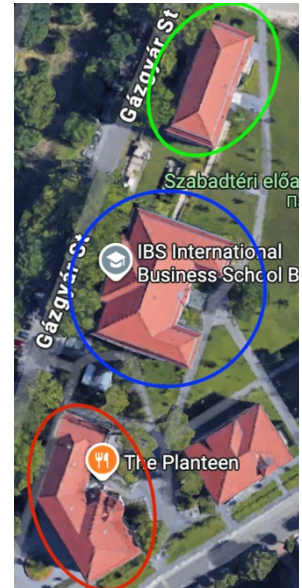
IBS consists of three adjacent buildings: the administration building, the classroom building, and the building housing the library and digital classrooms (with computers). This demonstrates that IBS has a **functional layout** where each process requires different areas. Each building has restrooms and its own outdoor area.

Pictured:

Green - library and digital classrooms

Blue - main classroom building

Red - administration building



Relationship chart and evaluation

I divided the entire IBS into six zones: classrooms, classrooms (digital), library, restrooms, administration building, and outside area. I then assessed the importance of each location being close to another, after which I compiled a rough current layout and evaluated it.

1 Classrooms (regular)	O					
2 Classrooms (digital)	O	O	A			
3 Library			A	O	O	I
4 Toilets		I		U	O	E
5 Administration		E			O	
6 Outside area		O		I		

Codes	Closeness
A	Absolutely necessary
E	Especially important
I	Important
O	Ordinary OK
U	Unimportant
X	Undesirable

Current layout:

3	1	6
2	4	5

Value	Closeness	Occurrences	Satisfied	Percentage
A	Absolutely necessary	2	2	100%
E	Especially important	2	2	100%
I	Important	3	2	66,6%
O	Ordinary OK	7	7	100%
U	Unimportant	1	1	100%
X	Undesirable	0	0	100%

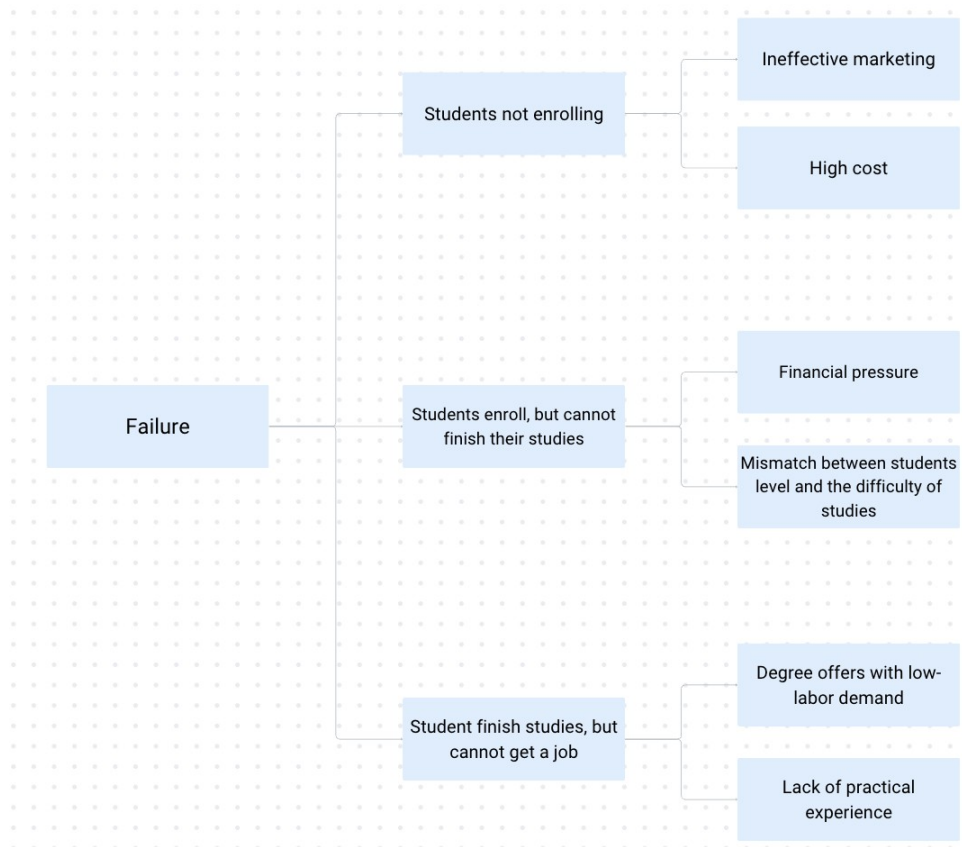
According to my evaluation, the current IBS layout is almost perfect. The only issue is the accessibility of the restroom to the library. There are no restrooms nearby on the first floor, where the library is located, and one is only available on the second floor, where the digital classrooms are located.

Quality assurance

IBS has a robust quality assurance system; it holds an operating license from the educational authority of Hungary, which means the university's data and programs are publicly available. IBS is also regularly assessed and audited by its partner, the University of Buckingham. It's also important to note that IBS holds accreditation from internationally recognized quality assurance agencies, such as the British Accreditation Council, which assures that IBS meets academic standards set by one of the leading agencies in the UK.

Most programs also hold a quality seal awarded by the Foundation for International Business Administration Accreditation, which assesses that IBS successfully meets global business education standards. (IBS, 2023)

Why-why analysis



Failure means that either students don't want to enroll in university, or students enroll but fail to complete their studies, or students graduate but can't find a job. Let's take this step by step, starting with the fact that students don't enroll at IBS. This may primarily be due to ineffective marketing. To get students in, you need to constantly make a name for yourself. Another reason could be the high cost; IBS has relatively high tuition fee for Hungary.

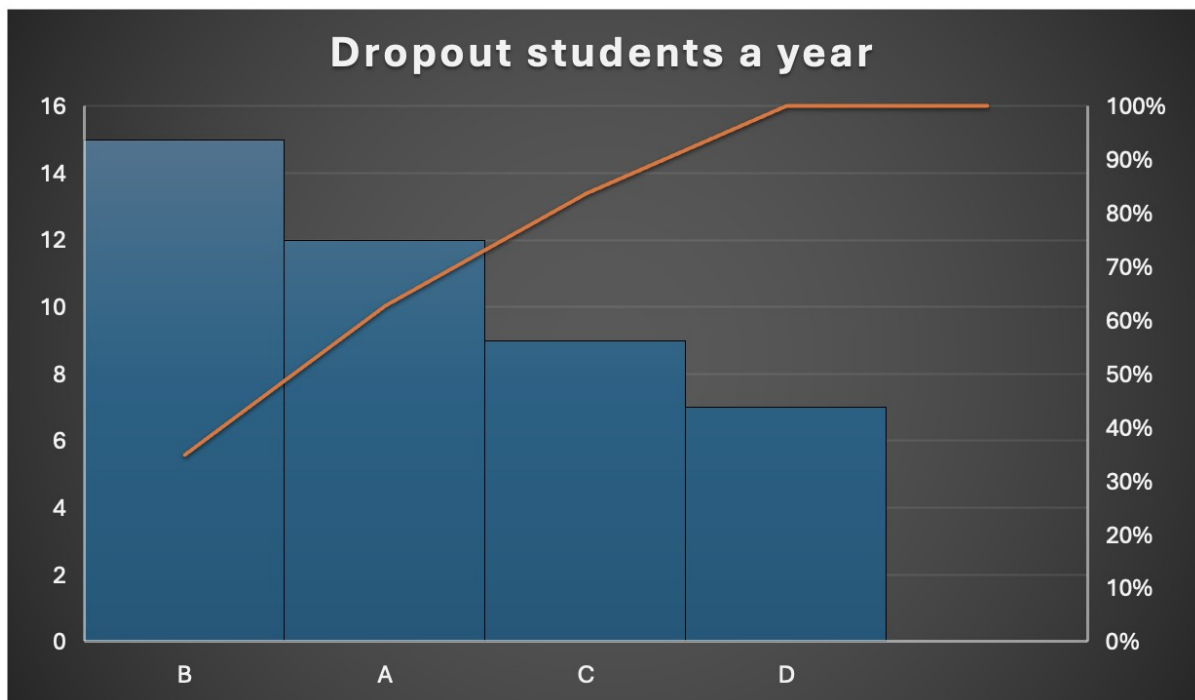
If students enroll but fail, it could be due to financial pressure or simply not being ready for the studies, for example, because their English is insufficient.

If students graduate but can't find a job, it could be due to a lack of real-world experience, when the university should be helping those looking to find work through its career services. It could also be because some programs aren't particularly relevant to the employer market.

Check list and pareto chart

A. Mismatch of level	12
B. Life circumstances	15
C. Financial pressure	9
D. Complicated grading	7

I calculated the approximate number of students who completed their studies without receiving a degree within one year, as well as the reasons A B C D why this happened, based on this Pareto chart.



Summary and evaluation

IBS follows all operating system standards very well, and this company is successful and will be even more successful in the future. However, to ensure everything is perfect, it's important to pay attention to small details.

5 performance objectives

Quality: IBS provides a high-quality education to its students, but I would focus more on hard skills in those programs where they are needed.

Speed: Overall, everything is good, but there may be issues with delays in grading, which can be caused by the teacher grading alone and without assistance.

Dependability: No issues at all, a highly feasible university.

Flexibility: Very flexible and constantly creating new programs to meet market needs.

Cost: This is where the main issues may arise. The cost is quite high for Hungary, and low-income families cannot afford the education.

Strategic importance

Following these recommendations is crucial if the university wants to attract even more talented students. Improving hard skills would increase graduate employability. Slow grading may risk reputation, while fast grading improves the student experience. High costs prevent the university from accessing most students; adjusting the cost would increase enrollment volumes. Communicating these recommendations is important for competitive positioning, student experience, and long-term sustainability. The proposed recommendations are highly supported by analytical tools used in this report.

Appendix

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AI Disclosure

In the process of writing this task, Microsoft Editor was only used after finishing the paper. The original work before the use of the grammar and spelling checking technology is being kept for the record. No additional AI tools were applied in the writing process